

UW-GRACE: Grant Automation for Compliance Efficiency

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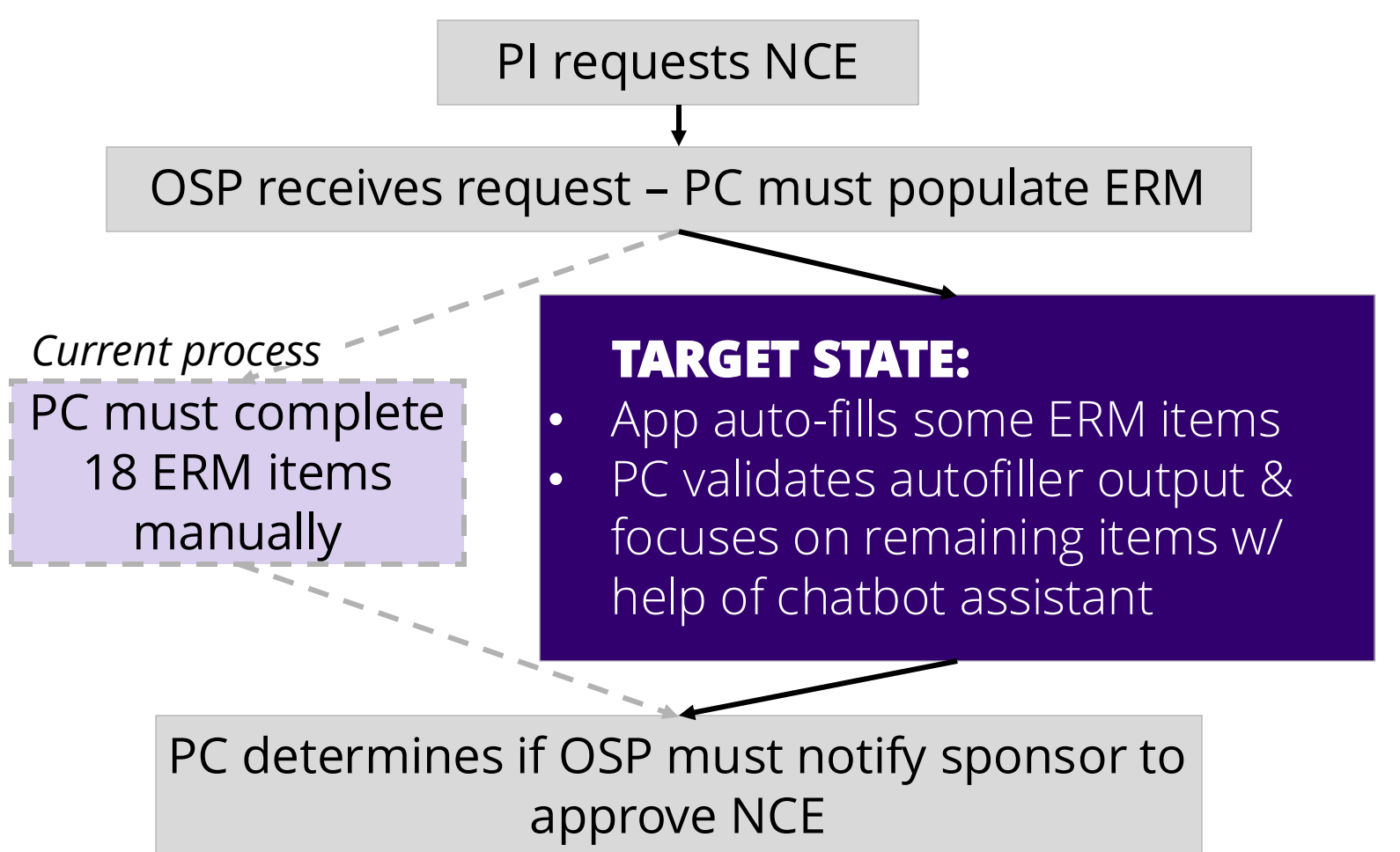


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INTRODUCTION

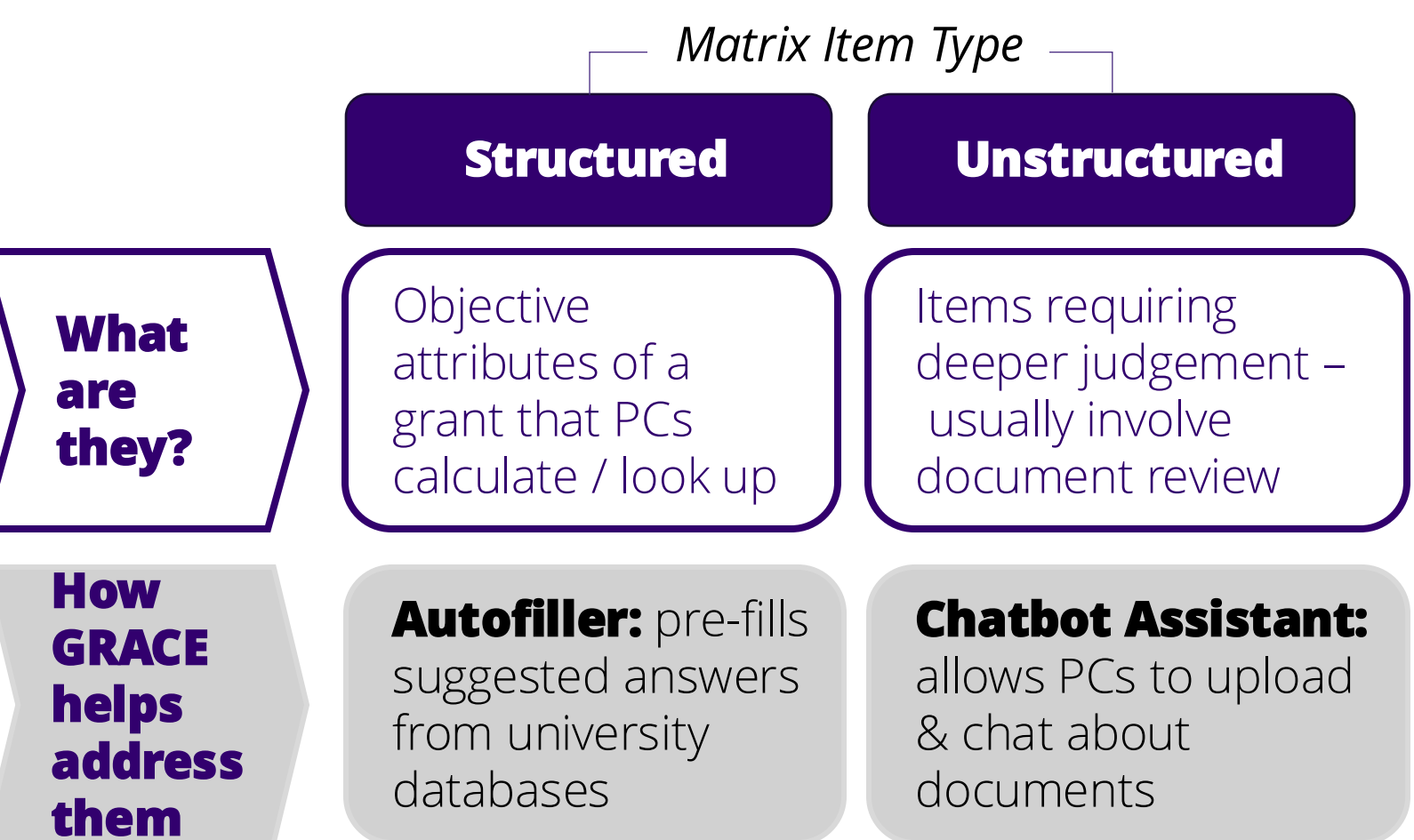
UW's Office of Sponsored Programs (OSP) works with primary investigators (PIs) to manage grants, contracts, and other sources of funding for their research activities. OSP processes **no cost extension (NCE)** requests submitted by PIs to extend a grant without modifying funding commitments. In some cases, the grant sponsor may need to approve an NCE. When a PI requests an NCE, Program Coordinators (PCs) complete an **extension review matrix (ERM)** to determine if sponsor approval is required. PCs balance these requests with other significant demands on their time; to ease their workload OSP approached the Scientific Software Engineering Center to explore possible automations.

OUR GOAL

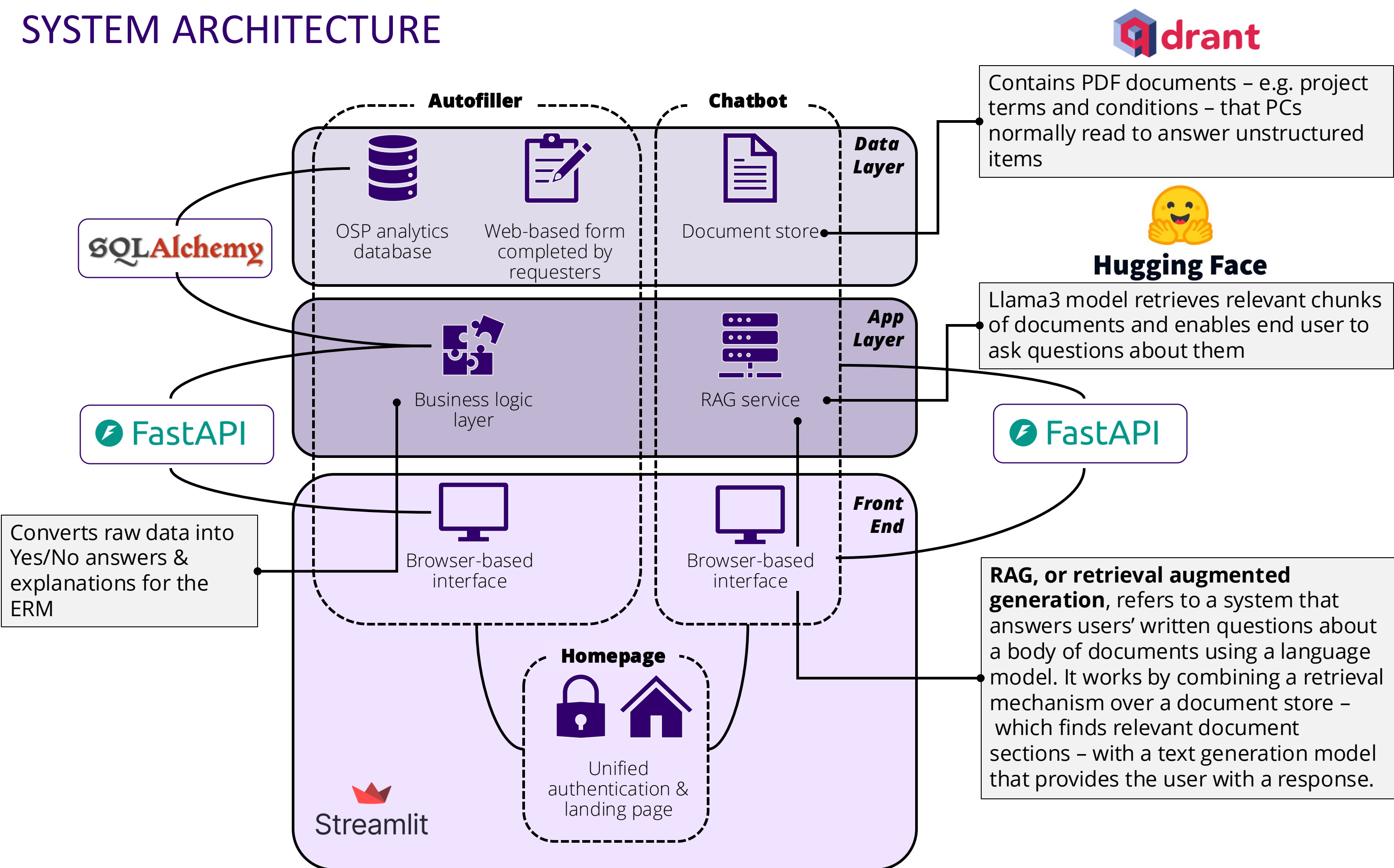


APPROACH

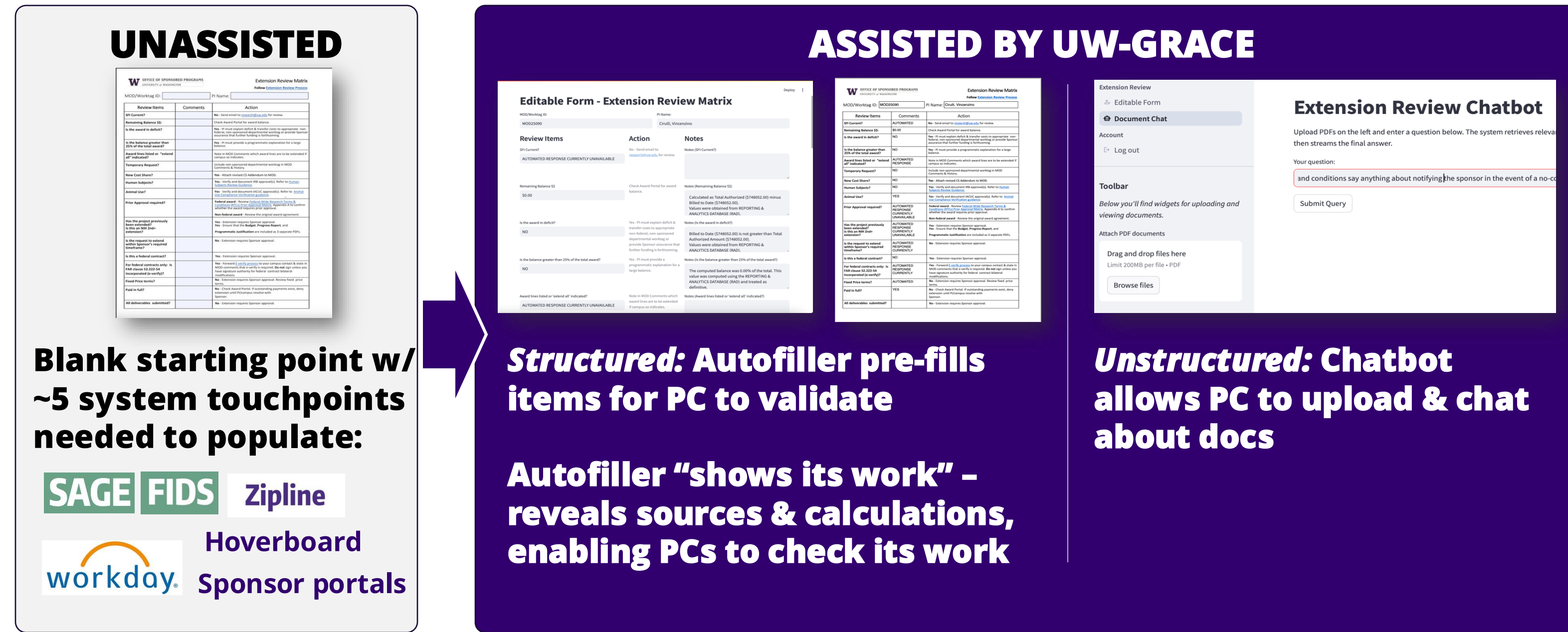
We identified two types of items on the ERM. To assist with both, we implemented a dual-track solution:



SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE



RESULTS



IMPACT



"I would find [this tool] very useful and it would make the process much faster"
-Program Coordinator

1. Assumes full data availability. Not applicable to all requests.
2. Rough estimate based on the length of time it takes to process a typical request, according to an OSP reviewer
3. Based on 2024 and early 2025 request volume

DISCUSSION

- Automating manual processes in research administration using AI can save significant time by:
 - Standardizing workflows and reducing errors
 - Expediting new employee training
 - Helping staff efficiently parse dense, jargon-filled docs
 - GRACE could be extended beyond NCE use case to assist with research proposal review
- Challenges:
- Evaluation of RAG tools for faithfulness, relevance, context precision and context recall are necessary next steps
 - Integrating this tool with current IT systems (security checks needed)
 - Testing rigorously to ensure end users trust output

NEXT STEPS

- Within the NCE process:
- Hand over the project to SSEC for ongoing maintenance as the Extension Review Matrix evolves
 - Migrate to a cloud service, likely AWS
 - Change database connections to production DBs and deploy via integration with SAGE (grant management platform)
- Other OSP processes:
- Apply methodology and technical assets, particularly RAG design, to assist Program Coordinators in other grant management activities

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